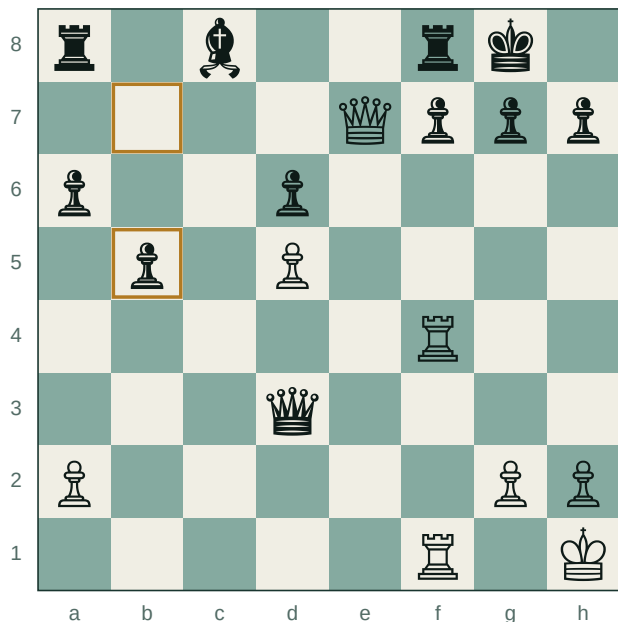


Attraction tactics: White, move 23

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 22...b5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23. Qxf8+ Kxf8 24. Rxf7+ Ke8 25. Rf8+ Kd7 26. R1f7#

23.Qxf8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f8 it attacks king on g8 and bishop on c8. Recorded reply: **23...Kxf8**.

24.Rxf7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on f7. Recorded reply: **24...Ke8**.

25.Rf8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **25...Kd7**.

26.R1f7# Mate: rook on f7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on d7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on f7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on d3. Check for tactical protection.